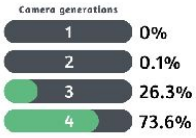
Malaysia

Identifying Malaysia



Malaysian licence plates are **black** and generally have **two** white sections. These are visible even when blurred.

*NOTE: Indonesian licence plates are also black, but they will have **three** white sections.*

Malaysia frequently uses **double white** centre lines on its two-lane roads. It is the only Southeast Asian country to do so.

These **thick yellow bars** are also almost exclusive to Malaysia.

NOTE: You can very rarely see similar patterns in [Hong Kong](#) and the [United Kingdom](#).

Electricity poles in Malaysia often have **black** or **white** stickers on them.

Sometimes you will also find red-and-white or red-and-blue stripes below the black sticker.

BERHENTI stop signs and **BERI LALUAN** yield signs are both unique to Malaysia.

Malaysian bollards will often have the colours **black**, **white**, **grey** and **red**. Here are three examples of typical Malaysian bollards.

NOTE: There can be multiple varieties of these bollards, but the layout is mostly the same.

This is a typical Malaysian directional sign. **Hexagonal yellow** highway shields are unique to Malaysia.

Malaysian kilometre markers have a unique **white-and-blue** colour scheme. Note that the hexagon shields are often visible.

Setiap orang adalah berhak kepada semua hak-hak dan kebebasan yang termaktub dalam Perisytiharan ini, tanpa sebarang apa jua pembezaan, seperti bangsa, warna kulit, jantina, bahasa, ugama, faham politik atau lain-lain fahaman, asal-usul bangsa keturunan atau sosial harta-benda, kelahiran atau apa-apa taraf lain.

The **Malay language** uses the Latin script. It is very closely related to Indonesian. These two languages are practically indistinguishable for people who do not speak either.

In contrast to neighbouring Indonesia, **Chinese characters** are often seen in Malaysia. In fact, 24.6% of the Malaysian population is of Chinese descent.

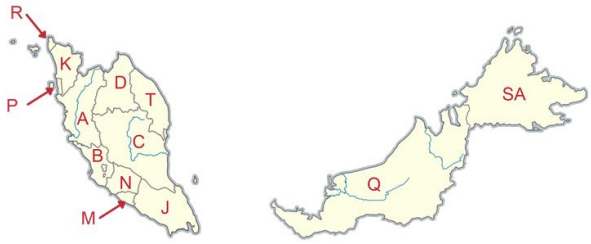
Signposts in Malaysia almost always have **black-and-white stripes**.

NOTE: Within Asia, these posts are also found in Sri Lanka, Bhutan, India, Nepal and Bangladesh. Make sure to check other clues before guessing.

Black-and-white curbs are commonly found in Malaysia.

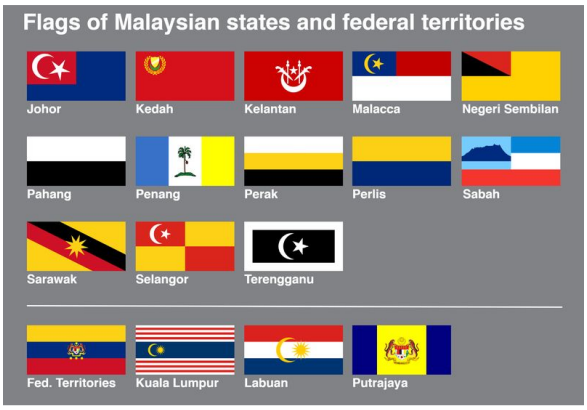
NOTE: Many other countries in Asia can also have black-and-white curbs.

Regional and state-specific clues

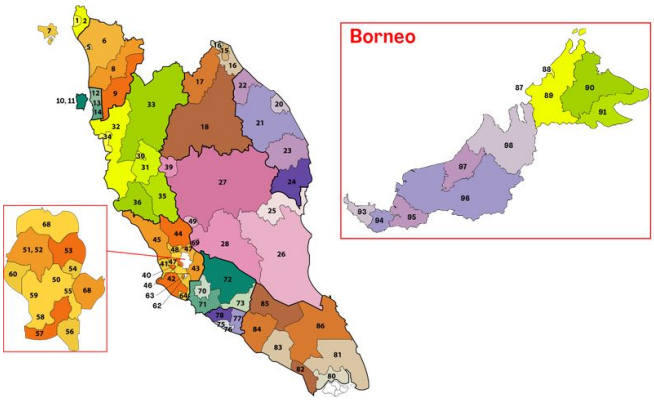


Each Malaysian state, excluding the three federal territories, has its own road numbering system with a **unique letter** at the start of the road number.

NOTE: Sabah also has A roads, but only the A2 and A7.



State flags can be seen with some regularity, so it is worth learning them.



Malaysian postal codes are useful to know, since they can be found on most street signs in the country.

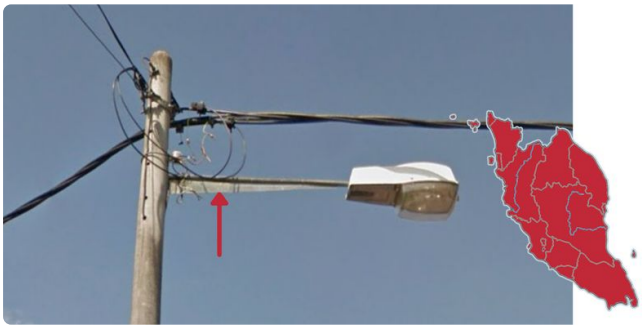
Black pole stickers are most commonly found on the mainland.

NOTE: The black stickers on Borneo only exist in Generation 4 coverage.

Black stickers with the text '**TEL TNB**' at the bottom, are only found in Johor.

White pole stickers are only found on electricity poles on the island of Borneo, in Sarawak.

Lamp posts with **two small circles** on the support are mainly found on mainland Malaysia.



Lamp posts with a **triangular metal support** are mainly found on mainland Malaysia.

Electricity poles on the Borneo side typically have a **2-1 insulator configuration**, and a long **diagonal wooden support**. They are exclusive to the Sarawak region of the island.

NOTE: Indonesian poles can look similar, but they are usually not made of wood, and use smaller or no diagonal supports.

Thin metal poles with **two parallel** pole tops are exclusive to the Sabah region of Borneo.

This lamp post with a supporting piece of sheet metal resembling a **boomerang** is found in Sarawak.

NOTE: It is more common in cities other than Kuching.

Trash bins with a **logo resembling an 'S'** are found in the states of Negeri Sembilan, Malacca and Johor.

Trash bins with a **logo resembling leaves** are found in Perlis and Kedah.

Trash bins with this logo featuring a **sunny landscape**, saying **'Alam Flora'** are found in Pahang, Kuala Lumpur and Putrajaya. The logo will occasionally be absent, and it will just say 'Alam Flora'.

Yellow street name signs with a black outline are specific to the state of Johor.

*NOTE: This **arrow-shaped** street sign, regardless of its colour, is exclusive to Malaysia.*

NOTE: Yellow signs are also found in southern Negeri Sembilan, however only the tip of the arrow will be black.

Green street signs that form an arrow shape and have a **yellow hexagonal symbol** with the letters **JKR** on the left side are found in Sabah.

Assuming you are on Borneo: the state of Sabah is **very mountainous**, and much of the coverage is on mountain roads like this one.

NOTE: Sarawak generally has flatter roads. Even if you see mountains, they will usually be at a distance.

These **isolated rock formations**, rising abruptly from an otherwise flat landscape, can be found near the Thai border in Perlis state.

Spotlight

Urban areas in Labuan are dotted with **blue cylindrical containers**.

This unique **grey car** with a long front antenna can be found in Gunung Mulu National Park, Sarawak.